

Mustangs Ahead

A run-through for the 18-slide Lakewood Ranch presentation to the principal. Bold lines are yours to say. Grey lines are what to do while you say them.

≈ 8 minutes

18 slides

2 slides that matter

BEFORE YOU START

- 1. Never say the school looks bad.** You're solving a coordination problem, not a taste problem. Every version on that wall was somebody doing their best with the file they had.
- 2. Say "I'm proposing," not "is it okay if."** You already did the work. Bring it as a proposal, not a request for permission.
- 3. The opening and the last slide are the pitch.** Everything in between can move quickly. Those two you slow down for, and you let the silence sit.

THE RUN

1 Who you are, and the problem **HOLD**

75 sec

"I'm Bronx — I'm a freshman here. I design brand systems. I did the yearbook cover last year, and a short film that won at Manatee Film Rush."

"This is something I made on my own time. Nobody asked me for it, and it isn't official — I'm bringing it to you as a proposal."

- ▶ Saying "nobody asked me" up front kills the "who authorised this?" question before anyone thinks to ask it.

"Lakewood Ranch has a strong identity, and people here are genuinely proud of it. So this isn't about anything looking bad."

"It's that there are at least five different horses on campus right now — the scoreboard, the band trailer, the banners, the parking sign — in greens that run from almost black to teal. None of them know about each other."

- ▶ Then stop for a second. There's no photo slide any more, so let them picture it — these are things they walk past every day.

2-3 The system

60 sec

"So I drew one. One lockup, one emblem, and every reduction that comes off it."

"Twenty-five marks in seven families — the emblem, the wordmarks, the mustang on its own, the band, a graduation crest, the newsletter and podcast, and some retro marks."

- ▶ Don't read the boards. They're there as reference for anyone who wants detail later — not a script.
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4 Every department

45 sec

"This is the part I think matters most for you. Every department gets a mark built for what it actually does."

"Athletics and the whole school use the emblem. The front office uses the wordmark. The band has its own. Graduation gets a crest — founded 1998 — for diplomas and programmes. And the newsletter and the podcast finally share one name."

- ▶ Point at the department, not the logo. You're showing them their own school, sorted — that's what they're deciding on, not the artwork.
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5 The full set

15 sec

"And that's all twenty-five. It's supplied as SVG, so none of it can get stretched or recoloured by accident."

- ▶ Don't read the grid. The printout has one page per mark for anyone who wants the detail later.
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6 The crest

20 sec

"This one's for the big occasions — the crest. Diplomas, the graduation programme, awards."

"It's the most formal mark in the system, so the idea is it only comes out for the moments that should feel permanent."

- ▶ Give it a second before you move on. It's the most detailed artwork in the deck, and it's the one families actually keep.
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7 Before / after

30 sec

"Left is the emblem the school uses now. Right is the same idea, redrawn on a single grid."

"The horse sits inside the L instead of across it, the outline is one consistent weight — and it still reads at the size of a browser tab."

8 One horse, drawn once

15 sec

"One horse. One green. One file — the same one on a scoreboard, a jersey, and a website tab."

- Say the line, then let the slide sit for a second before you move. It's the answer to the five horses you described at the start.

9–13 Colour, type, icons, voice

60 sec

"Colour, type, icons and voice are all documented the same way."

"The part I'd point at is the voice section. A brand that only governs logos doesn't really govern anything — so this is written for staff, not for designers."

- Move briskly. This block is proof of thoroughness, not a place to teach. If someone wants detail they'll stop you.

14 The sign

30 sec

"This is a sign that's on campus right now. The horse is sitting on top of the words, so you can't really read either."

"Same wall, same words — just set in the new type on the school green, with the horse moved into the background."

- Point at the left one first and let them find the problem themselves. Then the right one does the talking.

15 Posters

20 sec

"And two posters from the same system — the name for walls and the stadium, and one for game week."

- Keep this one quick. The point is that the poster, the sign and the wallpaper all come from the same parts.

16 Apparel

30 sec

"This is where students actually meet it. Spirit wear is the biggest run the school prints every year."

"Embroidery, one-colour print, sublimation, a stitched patch — all five of these come off the same file."

- If anyone in the room orders apparel, watch them here. This is the slide that makes it real for them.

17 Game day

15 sec

"And the red only turns up here. Game day is the one place it runs at full volume."

"Everything is on my site — every mark, the full guidelines, and photos of the horses on campus today. That code goes straight there."

- ▶ Slow down. The ask slide is gone, so this is where you make it — out loud, with the code still up.

"I'm not asking you to replace anything. Nothing gets thrown away. And it's free — no licence, no invoice. I'm a student here and I made it for the school."

"Digital and social could change today at no cost. Print changes as stock runs out. Signage only changes when it was getting replaced anyway."

"So what I'm actually asking for is permission to hand the files to whoever runs athletics, the band, graduation and the newsletter. Thank you for the time."

- ▶ Then stop. Don't fill the silence, and don't add anything to sweeten it — the ask is already small. Let them answer, and leave the code up while you take questions.

WHAT THEY'LL ASK

Six questions worth having an answer ready for. Say them plainly — none of these need defending.

"Who asked you to do this?"

→ Nobody. I did it because I care about the school and I wanted the practice. That's also why it's free.

"What does this cost us?"

→ Nothing. No licence, no invoice. I hand over the files and a short usage guide, and that's the whole transaction.

"Do we have to replace all our signage?"

→ No — and I'd recommend you don't. Use it on things you're already reprinting and let the rest age out on its own schedule.

"Has the district approved this?"

→ No. It's a concept, and the first slide says so. If it were ever taken further that's a conversation I'd want to be part of, but it's your call, not mine.

"What if we want to keep the old emblem too?"

→ That's fine. The retired marks are in the file for reference so nobody reuses them by accident, but nothing stops you keeping one in circulation.

"Why should we take a student's word on this?"

→ You shouldn't take it on faith — take it on the work. It's all finished and on the site, so you can check every piece of it yourself.

IF THE ROOM GOES QUIET

Don't oversell into silence. Shrink the ask instead — one programme, one file, one term.

"If that's too much at once — could I just give the band the band mark? That's one file and one programme, and it would tell us pretty quickly whether this is worth doing."

- ▶ The band is your easiest first yes. Their trailer has two different horses on it right now. That problem is visibly theirs, which makes your director the natural person to champion it.

Before you leave the room: hand them the deck, and ask for one name — whoever actually orders spirit wear or signage. That's the person who can say yes to something small, and small is what you're after.